University of Calicut · B.A. History

History of Keralam up to 12th Century · Comprehensive MCQ Question Bank

100 Curated MCQs across Modules 1–4 with Verified Answers and Detailed Explanations

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Q1. What is the total geographical area of Kerala?

(A) [CORRECT] 38,863 square kilometres

(B) 45,210 square kilometres

(C) 32,114 square kilometres

(D) 51,200 square kilometres

Answer: (A) | *Concept: Geographical Area of Kerala*

Explanation: According to the official geographical survey and university curriculum, Kerala forms a narrow strip of land along the southwest coast of India with a total area of 38,863 square kilometres.

Q2. Into how many distinct longitudinal physical zones is Kerala traditionally divided based on elevation?

(A) Two (Highland and Lowland)

(B) [CORRECT] Three (Highland, Midland, and Lowland)

(C) Four (Plateau, Hills, Plains, and Coast)

(D) Five (based on the five ancient Tinais)

Answer: (B) | *Concept: Three Physical Divisions of Kerala*

Explanation: Kerala is physically classified into three parallel longitudinal zones: High-land (Malanad, above 75 metres), Mid-land (Idanad, between 7.5 and 75 metres), and Low-land (Theerarambham/Kadaloram, below 7.5 metres).

Q3. What is the average width of the famous Palakkad Gap (Palghat Gap) in the Western Ghats?

(A) Approximately 10 kilometres

(B) Approximately 60 kilometres

(C) [CORRECT] Approximately 30 kilometres

(D) Approximately 90 kilometres

Answer: (C) | *Concept: The Palakkad Gap*

Explanation: The Palakkad Gap is a prominent natural discontinuity in the Western Ghats measuring approximately 30 kilometres in width, situated between the Nilgiri hills to the north and the Anamalai hills to the south.

Q4. Which mountain pass connects the port city of Kollam with Tirunelveli in southern Tamil Nadu?

(A) Tamarassery Pass

(B) Perambadi Pass

(C) Bodinayakkanur Pass

(D) [CORRECT] Aryankavu Pass

Answer: (D) | *Concept: Aryankavu Mountain Pass*

Explanation: The Aryankavu Pass, situated at an elevation of about 400 metres, served as the principal southern overland trade artery linking the historic seaport of Quilon (Kollam) with Tirunelveli and southern Tamil Nadu.

Q5. How many total rivers flow through Kerala, and how many flow westward into the Arabian Sea?

(A) [CORRECT] Total 44 rivers; 41 westward, 3 eastward

(B) Total 41 rivers; 38 westward, 3 eastward

(C) Total 44 rivers; all 44 westward

(D) Total 40 rivers; 35 westward, 5 eastward

Answer: (A) | *Concept: Hydrography and River Systems of Kerala*

Explanation: Kerala has 44 major rivers in total. Of these, 41 flow westward down the steep slopes of the Western Ghats into the Arabian Sea and coastal backwaters, while 3 flow eastward (Kabani, Bhavani, and Pambar) to join the Cauvery river system.

Q6. Which is the longest river in Kerala?

(A) Bharathapuzha (Nila)

(B) [CORRECT] Periyar

(C) Pamba

(D) Chaliyar

Answer: (B) | *Concept: Longest River: Periyar*

Explanation: The Periyar is the longest river in Kerala, with a total length of 244 kilometres. It originates in the Sivagiri hills of the Western Ghats and flows past Aluva into the Arabian Sea.

Q7. Which river in Kerala is celebrated as the cradle of Kerala's culture and is also known as Nila?

(A) Periyar

(B) Chaliyar

(C) [CORRECT] Bharathapuzha

(D) Kallada

Answer: (C) | *Concept: Bharathapuzha (Nila) and Cultural Heritage*

Explanation: Bharathapuzha (209 km), historically known as Nila, is revered as the cultural lifeline of Kerala, on whose banks historical assemblies like the Mamankam were celebrated at Thirunavaya.

Q8. Which of the following is the largest backwater (Kayal) lake in Kerala?

(A) Ashtamudi Kayal

(B) Sasthamkotta Lake

(C) Kavvayi Kayal

(D) [CORRECT] Vembanad Kayal

Answer: (D) | *Concept: Vembanad Lake*

Explanation: Vembanad Kayal is the largest lake in Kerala and the longest lake in India, spanning the districts of Ernakulam, Alappuzha, and Kottayam, covering over 200 sq km.

Q9. What is the unique morphological characteristic that gives Ashtamudi Kayal its name?

(A) [CORRECT] It possesses eight radiating branches or arms ('braids')

(B) It is fed by eight distinct mountain rivers

(C) It has eight historic European forts along its perimeter

(D) It spans across eight administrative taluks

Answer: (A) | *Concept: Morphology of Ashtamudi Kayal*

Explanation: Ashtamudi derives its name from 'Ashta' (eight) and 'Mudi' (braids/branches), describing its unique palm-shaped topography where eight major arms radiate from its central water basin.

Q10. Which soil type is most extensively distributed across the midland (Idanad) tract of Kerala?

(A) Black cotton soil

(B) [CORRECT] Laterite soil

(C) Peat (Kari) soil

(D) Saline soil

Answer: (B) | *Concept: Laterite Soils of Kerala*

Explanation: Laterite soil (formed by intense weathering under tropical monsoon conditions with alternating wet and dry spells) covers nearly 65% of Kerala's landmass, dominating the midland undulating hillocks.

Q11. What are the distinctive characteristics of the 'Kari' soils found in the Kuttanad region?

(A) Coarse sandy soils formed by marine deposits along sea dunes

(B) Alkaline red loamy soils occurring in high altitude tea estates

(C) [CORRECT] Deep black, highly acidic peat soils occurring 1–2 metres below sea level with submerged timber remains

(D) Fertile riverine silt deposits flooded annually by mountain torrents

Answer: (C) | *Concept: Kari Soils of Kuttanad*

Explanation: Kari soils are peculiar black peat soils found in patches across Alappuzha and Kottayam (Kuttanad). Occurring 1–2 metres below mean sea level, they are poorly drained, highly acidic, and contain remnants of ancient submerged forests.

Q12. The Southwest Monsoon, which brings heavy rainfall to Kerala starting in early June, is traditionally known in Malayalam as:

(A) Thulavarsham

(B) Kumbhavarsham

(C) Kanni Veyil

(D) [CORRECT] Edavappathi

Answer: (D) | *Concept: Southwest Monsoon (Edavappathi)*

Explanation: The Southwest Monsoon hits Kerala around the middle of the Malayalam month of Edavam (early June), and is hence culturally and meteorologically known as 'Edavappathi'.

Q13. The Northeast Monsoon, active during October and November with evening thunderstorms, is designated in Kerala as:

(A) [CORRECT] Thulavarsham

(B) Edavappathi

(C) Chingakkalathu Mazha

(D) Makarakkulir

Answer: (A) | *Concept: Northeast Monsoon (Thulavarsham)*

Explanation: The Northeast Monsoon occurs during the Malayalam month of Thulam (October–November) and is universally called 'Thulavarsham'. It is characterized by cyclonic winds and afternoon/evening thunderstorms.

Q14. Which historic natural commodity from the Kerala hills was famously referred to in ancient Greco-Roman trade as 'Black Gold'?

(A) Cardamom

(B) [CORRECT] Black Pepper

(C) Cinnamon

(D) Sandalwood

Answer: (B) | *Concept: Black Pepper as 'Black Gold'*

Explanation: Black Pepper (Piper nigrum), indigenous to the evergreen forests of the Western Ghats, commanded astronomical value in classical Mediterranean markets, earning the famous epithet 'Black Gold' (Yavanapriya).

Q15. Which Greek navigator is credited with discovering the direct trans-oceanic monsoon route across the Arabian Sea to Malabar around 45–47 CE?

(A) Eratosthenes

(B) Megasthenes

(C) [CORRECT] Hippalus

(D) Strabo

Answer: (C) | *Concept: Hippalus and the Monsoon Wind*

Explanation: Hippalus, a Greek mariner, discovered the regular periodic nature of the Southwest monsoon winds (hence called the 'Hippalus Wind' in the Periplus), allowing ships to sail directly from the Gulf of Aden to Muziris in just 40 days.

Q16. Which plateau of the Western Ghats is the most extensive in Kerala, famous for ancient tea, coffee, and spice plantations?

(A) Chittoor Plateau

(B) Kuttanad Depression

(C) Onattukara Belt

(D) [CORRECT] Wayanad Plateau

Answer: (D) | *Concept: Wayanad Plateau*

Explanation: The Wayanad Plateau, standing at an elevation of 700 to 1200 metres, represents a contiguous extension of the Deccan/Mysore plateau into Kerala, renowned for prehistoric rock art and fertile spice plantations.

Q17. The Perambadi Pass in the Western Ghats provided a historical transport link between:

(A) [CORRECT] Kannur (Malabar) and Coorg (Kodagu)

(B) Kollam and Madurai

(C) Kochi and Coimbatore

(D) Thiruvananthapuram and Tirunelveli

Answer: (A) | *Concept: Perambadi Pass*

Explanation: The Perambadi Pass provided crucial access between northern Malabar (Kannur/Thalassery) and Coorg (Kodagu) on the Mysore plateau, serving military expeditions and pepper caravans.

Q18. Which European fort ruins located along the coastal mouth of Periyar remind us of the strategic role of waterways in maritime defence?

(A) Bekal Fort

(B) [CORRECT] Pallippuram Fort (Ayakkotta)

(C) Palakkad Fort

(D) Chitradurga Fort

Answer: (B) | *Concept: Pallippuram Fort and Coastal Defence*

Explanation: Pallippuram Fort (Ayakkotta), built by the Portuguese in 1503 on the northern tip of Vypin island near the mouth of the Periyar, is the oldest surviving European fort in India.

Q19. What is the geological epoch corresponding to the Palaeolithic period (Old Stone Age)?

(A) Holocene

(B) Pliocene

(C) [CORRECT] Pleistocene

(D) Miocene

Answer: (C) | *Concept: Pleistocene Epoch and Palaeolithic Age*

Explanation: The Palaeolithic Age coincides with the Pleistocene geological epoch (popularly known as the Great Ice Age), spanning from about 2.5 million years ago to roughly 10,000 BCE.

Q20. Which diagnostic stone tool industry is characteristic of the Lower Palaeolithic Acheulian culture?

(A) Polished celts and adzes

(B) Geometric microliths like trapezes and lunates

(C) Ground stone mortars and pestles

(D) [CORRECT] Bifacial hand-axes and cleavers

Answer: (D) | *Concept: Acheulian Hand-axe Industry*

Explanation: The Acheulian cultural tradition of the Lower Palaeolithic is distinguished worldwide by bifacially worked stone tools, predominantly pear-shaped hand-axes and cleavers made by flaking quartz or quartzite.

Q21. Who is revered as the pioneer of prehistoric archaeology in India for discovering the first Palaeolithic hand-axe at Pallavaram in 1863?

(A) [CORRECT] Robert Bruce Foote

(B) Sir John Marshall

(C) Alexander Cunningham

(D) Mortimer Wheeler

Answer: (A) | *Concept: Robert Bruce Foote: Father of Indian Prehistory*

Explanation: Robert Bruce Foote, a British geologist of the Geological Survey of India, discovered the first Acheulian hand-axe at Pallavaram near Madras in 1863, establishing the deep antiquity of human presence in India.

Q22. In which river valley of Palakkad district were Lower and Middle Palaeolithic stone tools discovered in Kerala?

(A) Pamba valley

(B) [CORRECT] Walayar and Kanjirapuzha valleys

(C) Kallada valley

(D) Irikkur valley

Answer: (B) | *Concept: Palaeolithic Discoveries in Palakkad*

Explanation: Systematic surveys by archaeologists including P. Rajendran in the Walayar, Kanjirapuzha, and Malampuzha basins of Palakkad revealed Acheulian hand-axes, scrapers, and cleavers, establishing Palaeolithic occupation in Kerala.

Q23. What primary lifestyle characterized human societies during the Palaeolithic period?

(A) Settled urban commerce and maritime trade

(B) Intensive wet-rice cultivation

(C) [CORRECT] Nomadic hunting and gathering

(D) Pastoralism with domesticated horses

Answer: (C) | *Concept: Palaeolithic Hunter-Gatherer Economy*

Explanation: Palaeolithic humans lived in small bands as mobile hunter-gatherers, moving seasonally across landscapes following game and foraging wild roots, tubers, berries, and fruits.

Q24. What is the technical term for the miniature stone tools that define the Mesolithic period?

(A) Macroliths

(B) Megaliths

(C) Monoliths

(D) [CORRECT] Microliths

Answer: (D) | *Concept: Microliths of the Mesolithic Age*

Explanation: The Mesolithic (Middle Stone Age) is technologically defined by 'microliths'—tiny stone tools typically between 1 and 5 cm in length, such as blades, lunates, triangles, and trapezes mounted onto wood or bone handles.

Q25. Which celebrated rock shelter in Kollam district yielded evidence of Mesolithic habitation and microliths dated to around 4000 BCE?

(A) [CORRECT] Tenmalai (Thenmala)

(B) Edakkal

(C) Porkalam

(D) Cheruvannur

Answer: (A) | *Concept: Tenmalai Mesolithic Rock Shelter*

Explanation: The Tenmalai rock shelter in Kollam district was excavated by archaeologist P. Rajendran, yielding classic geometric microliths and wood charcoal dated by radiocarbon to circa 4000 BCE.

Q26. Which of the following is an essential hallmark that distinguishes the Neolithic Age from preceding stone ages?

(A) Invention of iron smelting and steel swords

(B) [CORRECT] Ground and polished stone axes, agriculture, and animal domestication

(C) Minting of punched-marked silver coinage

(D) Manufacture of crude Acheulian hand-axes

Answer: (B) | *Concept: Hallmarks of the Neolithic Revolution*

Explanation: The Neolithic ('New Stone Age') is characterized by polished stone celts, the dawn of plant cultivation (agriculture), domestication of animals, settled village life, and pottery making.

Q27. In which region of Kerala were polished stone celts and beads characteristic of the Neolithic phase discovered?

(A) Kuttanad in Alappuzha

(B) Varkala cliff beach

(C) [CORRECT] Kalpetta and Pulppalli in Wayanad

(D) Munambam fishing harbour

Answer: (C) | *Concept: Neolithic Sites in Wayanad*

Explanation: Neolithic ground stone celts and beads have been reported from Kalpetta, Pulppalli, and Sultan Bathery in the Wayanad highland plateau, as well as along the upper Periyar bed near Alwaye.

Q28. Why do archaeologists consider the Neolithic phase in Kerala to have been relatively brief?

(A) Because early communities quickly migrated to Sri Lanka

(B) Because torrential monsoon rains destroyed all polished tools

(C) Because bronze technology was adopted for thousands of years

(D) [CORRECT] Because it was swiftly overlapped and replaced by the Iron Age Megalithic culture

Answer: (D) | *Concept: Brief Neolithic Transition in Kerala*

Explanation: In Kerala, the Neolithic phase was relatively brief because the region transitioned rapidly from late stone tool usage directly into the Iron Age Megalithic culture around 1000 BCE, largely bypassing an extensive Chalcolithic phase.

Q29. What raw material was predominantly flaked to manufacture microliths in prehistoric Kerala?

(A) [CORRECT] Quartz and chert

(B) Limestone and marble

(C) Soft soapstone

(D) Pure copper ingots

Answer: (A) | *Concept: Raw Materials for Microliths*

Explanation: Mesolithic hunter-gatherers in Kerala extensively utilized milky vein quartz, crystal quartz, and chert flaked from river gravels to produce sharp-edged microlithic blades and points.

Q30. Which of the following is a recognized Mesolithic microlithic site in Ernakulam district?

(A) Fort Kochi

(B) [CORRECT] Keezhillam

(C) Aluva Manappuram

(D) Mattancherry

Answer: (B) | *Concept: Keezhillam Mesolithic Site*

Explanation: Keezhillam in Ernakulam district is an identified prehistoric site where surface explorations recovered Mesolithic quartz flakes and core tools.

Q31. What is the primary archaeological method used to identify the relative age of prehistoric stone tool horizons in river valleys?

(A) Epigraphical paleography

(B) Numismatic comparison

(C) [CORRECT] Stratigraphy and river terrace analysis

(D) Linguistic etymology

Answer: (C) | *Concept: Stratigraphic and Terrace Dating*

Explanation: In river valley contexts, geologists and prehistorians study river terraces (T1, T2, T3) and geological stratigraphy (layering of gravels and silts) to determine relative cultural chronologies.

Q32. Which transition in human lifestyle marks the boundary between the Mesolithic and Neolithic periods?

(A) The discovery of gunpowder

(B) The introduction of factory machinery

(C) The emergence of steam navigation

(D) [CORRECT] Shift from pure food gathering to food production (agriculture and domestication)

Answer: (D) | *Concept: The Neolithic Shift to Food Production*

Explanation: V. Gordon Childe coined the phrase 'Neolithic Revolution' to describe the profound economic transformation from parasitic foraging (hunting/gathering) to food production (agriculture and pastoralism).

Q33. What kind of edge did Neolithic celts possess, compared to earlier Palaeolithic bifaces?

(A) [CORRECT] Ground, pecked, and polished symmetrical cutting edges

(B) Jagged, untrimmed flaked flint

(C) Cast bronze serrated saws

(D) Unmodified river pebbles

Answer: (A) | *Concept: Polished Neolithic Celts*

Explanation: Neolithic stone axes (celts) were manufactured through systematic pecking, grinding, and polishing against abrasive rock slabs to produce razor-sharp, symmetrical cutting edges suitable for felling timber and tilling soil.

Q34. Which of the following sites in Palakkad district has yielded prehistoric microlithic artifacts?

(A) Guruvayur

(B) [CORRECT] Anakkara

(C) Vaikom

(D) Ponnani Port

Answer: (B) | *Concept: Anakkara Prehistoric Site*

Explanation: Anakkara, situated in the Bharathapuzha basin in Palakkad, is an established prehistoric site where archaeologists recovered microlithic stone tools and Megalithic burial remnants.

Q35. What is the key technical difference between 'petroglyphs' and 'pictographs' in prehistoric rock art?

(A) Petroglyphs are painted on wood, while pictographs are carved on stone

(B) Petroglyphs depict only animals, while pictographs depict only geometric shapes

(C) [CORRECT] Petroglyphs are carved/incised into rock surfaces, while pictographs are painted with pigments

(D) Petroglyphs belong to the Iron Age, while pictographs are strictly Palaeolithic

Answer: (C) | *Concept: Petroglyphs vs. Pictographs*

Explanation: In archaeology, 'petroglyphs' refer to rock engravings made by pecking, incising, or carving into the bedrock. 'Pictographs' refer to rock paintings created using natural mineral pigments (like hematite red ochre or kaolin white).

Q36. Where is the world-renowned Edakkal Cave situated?

(A) Ezhimala Hills in Kannur

(B) Agasthyarkoodam in Thiruvananthapuram

(C) Nelliyampathi Hills in Palakkad

(D) [CORRECT] Ambukuthi Hills near Sultan Bathery, Wayanad

Answer: (D) | *Concept: Location of Edakkal Cave*

Explanation: Edakkal Cave is located on Ambukuthi Mala (hills) near Ambalavayal, about 12 km from Sultan Bathery in Wayanad district, at an altitude of approximately 1,200 metres.

Q37. Who discovered the prehistoric rock engravings of Edakkal Cave in 1894?

(A) [CORRECT] Fred Fawcett

(B) Robert Bruce Foote

(C) James Babington

(D) Benjamin Ward

Answer: (A) | *Concept: Discovery of Edakkal Cave by Fred Fawcett*

Explanation: Fred Fawcett, the Superintendent of Police in Malabar, discovered the Edakkal rock engravings in 1894 while on an excursion, publishing his pioneering findings in the 'Indian Antiquary' in 1901.

Q38. Geomorphologically, why is Edakkal technically not a true cavern, and what does its name mean?

(A) It is an artificial underground tunnel dug by medieval kings

(B) [CORRECT] It is a natural cleft where a huge rock wedge got stuck between two massive rocks ('stone in between')

(C) It is a volcanic crater formed by lava eruption

(D) It is a laterite quarry pit hollowed out by ancient builders

Answer: (B) | *Concept: Geomorphic Structure of Edakkal*

Explanation: 'Edakkal' literally translates to 'a stone in between' (Eda + Kal). It is a fissure rock shelter formed when a massive boulder split from the cliff and lodged tightly between two huge vertical rock walls, forming a roof.

Q39. Which iconic anthropomorphic motif is famously etched on the rock surface of Edakkal Cave?

(A) A Greek goddess wearing a laurel wreath

(B) A Roman emperor seated on an ivory throne

(C) [CORRECT] A stylized human figure with an elaborate conical headgear / head-dress

(D) A medieval knight wielding an iron cross

Answer: (C) | *Concept: Anthropomorphic Motifs at Edakkal*

Explanation: Edakkal is celebrated for its mysterious anthropomorphic engravings, most notably the 'man with headgear' or ritual mask, accompanied by a female figure with square-headed headdress and ritual dancers.

Q40. What vehicular representation at Edakkal Cave has been widely discussed by archaeologists as evidence of transport technology?

(A) A double-decker sailing ship

(B) A four-horse iron war chariot

(C) A steam locomotive

(D) [CORRECT] A wheeled cart with spoked wheels and a driver

Answer: (D) | *Concept: The Wheeled Cart Motif at Edakkal*

Explanation: On the extreme left wall at Edakkal, there is an engraving of a wheeled vehicle with adjoining circular spoked motifs and an associated figure, widely interpreted by scholars as an early wheeled cart.

Q41. Where is the famous rock painting (pictograph) site of Marayur located?

(A) [CORRECT] In the Anjunad Valley along the Pambar river in Idukki district

(B) Near the mouth of Bharathapuzha in Malappuram

(C) In the Silent Valley National Park in Palakkad

(D) On the coastal cliffs of Bekal in Kasaragod

Answer: (A) | *Concept: Location of Marayur Rock Art*

Explanation: Marayur rock art sites (including Ezhuthupara, Attala, and Pathipara) are situated in the Chinnar Wildlife Sanctuary and Anjunad valley along the Pambar river in Idukki district, also renowned for sandalwood forests and dolmens.

Q42. What colors of mineral pigment dominate the rock paintings at Marayur?

(A) Bright blue and emerald green

(B) [CORRECT] Red ochre (hematite) and white (kaolin)

(C) Gold leaf and silver foil

(D) Synthetic coal tar black only

Answer: (B) | *Concept: Pigments in Marayur Rock Paintings*

Explanation: Prehistoric rock artists at Marayur utilized locally sourced natural earth pigments, primarily red ochre (derived from iron oxide/hematite) and white pigment (derived from kaolin or lime).

Q43. What is meant by the archaeological term 'superimposition' observed in rock art?

(A) Constructing a stone roof over an outdoor cave

(B) Burying cave paintings under layers of sand to preserve them

(C) [CORRECT] Painting or engraving new motifs directly over older, pre-existing figures

(D) Using mirrors to project outdoor sunlight into cave interiors

Answer: (C) | *Concept: Superimposition in Rock Art*

Explanation: 'Superimposition' occurs when prehistoric artists etched or painted figures directly on top of older designs, creating stratified visual layers that help archaeologists determine relative chronological sequences.

Q44. Which of the following animals is frequently depicted in the rock paintings of Marayur?

(A) Polar bear

(B) Kangaroo

(C) African giraffe

(D) [CORRECT] Humped bull and cattle

Answer: (D) | *Concept: Faunal Depictions at Marayur*

Explanation: Rock art in the Chinnar-Marayur belt prominently depicts humped cattle (zebu), wild sambar, deer, elephant, and hunting scenes, illustrating both wild fauna and pastoral domestication.

Q45. Which other rock shelter in Wayanad, located near Edakkal, is noted for prehistoric geometric petroglyphs?

(A) [CORRECT] Tovari (Thovari)

(B) Agumbe

(C) Attappadi

(D) Devikulam

Answer: (A) | *Concept: Tovari Rock Shelter*

Explanation: Tovari (Thovari) rock shelter, located near Ambalavayal in Wayanad, contains ancient geometric petroglyphs and symbolic incised patterns closely related to the cultural horizon of Edakkal.

Q46. What is the primary interpretation accepted by modern archaeologists regarding the function of prehistoric rock art?

(A) Commercial advertising boards for metal merchants

(B) [CORRECT] Ritualistic, totemic, and sympathetic magic associated with subsistence, hunting, and spiritual beliefs

(C) Tax assessment records etched by imperial accountants

(D) Bilingual textbooks for teaching children grammar

Answer: (B) | *Concept: Ritual and Sympathetic Function of Rock Art*

Explanation: Anthropologists and archaeologists view rock art as symbolic expressions of early human belief systems—serving totemic clan identity, shamanic hunting rituals (sympathetic magic), fertility rites, and communication with spirits.

Q47. Which rock shelter located in southern Kerala (Thiruvananthapuram district) contains remarkable geometric and anthropomorphic engravings?

(A) Chitharal Cave

(B) Kaviyoor Cave

(C) [CORRECT] Ancode Cave

(D) Vizhinjam Cave

Answer: (C) | *Concept: Ancode Cave Petroglyphs*

Explanation: The Ancode rock shelter in Thiruvananthapuram district features distinct prehistoric geometric engravings, intersecting triangles, and anthropomorphic motifs representing early communal life.

Q48. What geometric figure, symbolizing structural rigidity and stability, is frequently incised in the rock art of Edakkal and Ancode?

(A) Parabolas

(B) Pentagons

(C) Hyperbolas

(D) [CORRECT] Triangles

Answer: (D) | *Concept: Geometric Triangle Motifs in Rock Art*

Explanation: Triangles (formed by intersecting lines connecting three points) represent unalterable rigid geometric forms, prominently incised in both non-figurative symbolic compositions and anthropomorphic torsos at Edakkal and Ancode.

Q49. Why did pastoral communities during the prehistoric and Megalithic eras frequently utilize rock shelters in the Chinnar region?

(A) [CORRECT] As temporary pens to safeguard livestock and cattle overnight during seasonal migrations

(B) To mine uranium and bauxite

(C) As naval lighthouses overlooking the open ocean

(D) To hide paper banknotes from foreign tax collectors

Answer: (A) | *Concept: Pastoral Use of Chinnar Rock Shelters*

Explanation: Archaeological studies indicate that pastoral herders moving through the Chinnar/Marayur dry deciduous hill tracts used the rock shelters as overnight cattle folds to safeguard their livestock from predatory carnivores during transhumance.

Q50. Which early historic Tamil Brahmi inscription was discovered inscribed alongside the prehistoric petroglyphs at Edakkal Cave?

(A) Ashoka's 14th Major Rock Edict

(B) [CORRECT] An inscription mentioning 'I-Pazhama' or the Chera king Kadummi Puthak Chera

(C) The Allahabad Pillar Inscription of Samudragupta

(D) The Hathigumpha Inscription of Kharavela

Answer: (B) | *Concept: Tamil-Brahmi Inscriptions at Edakkal*

Explanation: In addition to prehistoric petroglyphs, epigraphists (like I. Mahadevan and M.R. Raghava Varier) deciphered Tamil-Brahmi inscriptions at Edakkal dating from c. 3rd century BCE to 4th century CE, referencing names like 'Kadummi Puthak Chera'.

Q51. What is the etymological origin of the term 'Megalith'?

(A) From Latin 'Magna' (great) and 'Liber' (book)

(B) From Sanskrit 'Maha' (great) and 'Loha' (iron)

(C) [CORRECT] From Greek 'Megas' (great/large) and 'Lithos' (stone)

(D) From Persian 'Mir' (chief) and 'Ghal' (fortress)

Answer: (C) | *Concept: Etymology of Megalith*

Explanation: The term 'Megalith' is derived from the Greek words 'megas' meaning large/huge and 'lithos' meaning stone, referring to monuments built of massive stone blocks without mortar during the Iron Age.

Q52. What broad chronological span is generally assigned to the Megalithic Culture (Iron Age) in Kerala and South India?

(A) Circa 50,000 BCE to 10,000 BCE

(B) Circa 1500 CE to 1800 CE

(C) Circa 5000 BCE to 4000 BCE

(D) [CORRECT] Circa 1000 BCE to 300/500 CE

Answer: (D) | *Concept: Chronology of South Indian Megalithic Culture*

Explanation: Radiocarbon determinations and stratigraphic excavations date South India's Megalithic (Iron Age) culture from approximately 1000 BCE to roughly 300/500 CE, overlapping into the Sangam / Early Historic period.

Q53. Which distinctive mushroom-shaped megalithic monument consists of four clinostats (curved upright stones) supporting a hemispherical capstone?

(A) [CORRECT] Topikkal (Hat Stone / Umbrella Stone)

(B) Menhir (Standing Stone)

(C) Dolmenoid cist

(D) Urn burial

Answer: (A) | *Concept: Topikkal (Hat Stone / Umbrella Stone)*

Explanation: Topikkal (Hat Stone or Umbrella Stone) is unique to Kerala: it consists of four unmortared inward-leaning curved laterite clinostats supporting a circular convex capstone, resembling a traditional palm-leaf umbrella.

Q54. What is a 'Kudakkal' (Hood Stone) in Kerala megalithic archaeology?

(A) A multi-storeyed iron watchtower

(B) [CORRECT] A dressed dome-shaped laterite stone placed flush over a burial pit without supporting pillars

(C) A wooden canoe filled with rice

(D) A bronze bell hung from a granite post

Answer: (B) | *Concept: Kudakkal (Hood Stone)*

Explanation: Kudakkal (Hood stone) is a solid, plano-convex, mushroom-shaped dressed block of laterite placed directly on the ground over a burial pit/urn without any supporting clinostat pillars.

Q55. What are single upright commemorative monoliths erected over megalithic burial sites called?

(A) Cists

(B) Sarcophagi

(C) [CORRECT] Menhirs (Pulachikallu / Nadukal)

(D) Dolmens

Answer: (C) | *Concept: Menhirs (Standing Stones)*

Explanation: Menhirs (known locally as Pulachikallu or Nadukal) are tall, monolithic standing stones erected vertically in memory of deceased ancestors or fallen warrior chieftains.

Q56. Which subterranean megalithic monument type is completely unique to the laterite rock formations of the Malabar coast in Kerala?

(A) Egyptian style stone pyramids

(B) Brick-built stupas with torana gates

(C) Timber log cabins

(D) [CORRECT] Rock-cut burial caves (e.g., Porkalam, Chovvannur, Eyyal)

Answer: (D) | *Concept: Rock-cut Burial Caves of Kerala*

Explanation: Rock-cut caves (carved into hard subterranean laterite with central pillars, benches, recessed niches, and circular ceiling openings) are virtually exclusive to Kerala, famously excavated at Chovvannur, Kandanissery, Porkalam, and Eyyal in Thrissur.

Q57. What is the traditional Malayalam term for large terracotta burial urns discovered across megalithic sites in Kerala?

(A) [CORRECT] Nannangadi (Muthumakkachadi)

(B) Nilavilakku

(C) Uruli

(D) Chempu

Answer: (A) | *Concept: Nannangadi (Urn Burials)*

Explanation: Large pyriform terracotta burial urns containing post-excarnation skeletal remains, iron tools, and pottery are called 'Nannangadi' or 'Muthumakkachadi' (jars of the ancient ancestors).

Q58. Who conducted the very first systematic excavation of megalithic monuments in India at Chettapparamba near Kozhikode in 1819?

(A) Lord Curzon

(B) [CORRECT] Dr. J. Babington

(C) Sir William Jones

(D) B.K. Thapar

Answer: (B) | *Concept: J. Babington's 1819 Excavation*

Explanation: Dr. J. Babington carried out the first recorded archaeological excavation of Megaliths in India at Chettapparamba near Kozhikode in 1819, describing the umbrella stones and rock-cut chambers in the 'Transactions of the Literary Society of Bombay'.

Q59. Which ceramic ware produced through inverted firing is the ubiquitous hallmark of South Indian megalithic burials?

(A) Painted Grey Ware (PGW)

(B) Northern Black Polished Ware (NBPW)

(C) [CORRECT] Black and Red Ware (BRW)

(D) Chinese Celadon Ware

Answer: (C) | *Concept: Black and Red Ware (BRW)*

Explanation: Black and Red Ware (BRW), manufactured by an inverted firing technique that turns the interior and rim black while the exterior turns red, is the premier diagnostic pottery found in almost every megalithic burial.

Q60. What distinctive surface decoration characterizes 'Russet Coated Painted Ware' (RCPW) found in Megalithic-Early Historic contexts?

(A) Gold gilt figures of Buddha

(B) Persian calligraphic verses etched with acid

(C) Inlaid shells depicting marine crabs

(D) [CORRECT] White kaolin paste rectilinear and curvilinear geometric designs beneath a russet-colored slip

Answer: (D) | *Concept: Russet Coated Painted Ware (RCPW)*

Explanation: Russet Coated Painted Ware (often called Andhra Ware) features white kaolin clay geometric patterns (wavy lines, dots, zig-zags) coated under a translucent russet-colored ochre wash.

Q61. Which metal objects form the most extensive category of utilitarian grave goods recovered from Kerala megaliths?

(A) [CORRECT] Iron implements (swords, daggers, axes, sickles, tripods, and billhooks)

(B) Cast aluminium vessels

(C) Titanium armours

(D) Stainless steel spoons

Answer: (A) | *Concept: Iron Objects in Megaliths*

Explanation: Megalithic tombs yield extensive iron artifacts: weapons (swords, daggers, spears, arrowheads, tridents) and agrarian tools (axes, sickles, spades, tripods), attesting to mature iron metallurgy.

Q62. What type of luxury semi-precious stone beads, chemically etched with permanent white alkaline patterns, were prized in megalithic burials?

(A) Synthetic plastic beads

(B) [CORRECT] Etched carnelian beads

(C) Diamond cut emeralds

(D) Polished coal cubes

Answer: (B) | *Concept: Etched Carnelian Beads*

Explanation: Etched carnelian beads (made of orange-red quartz etched with geometric patterns using plant alkaline juices like soda ash) were prestigious trade items placed with the deceased.

Q63. What funerary practice is reflected by the presence of only selected, broken bone fragments in megalithic urns rather than complete skeletons?

(A) Primary immediate burial

(B) Mummification using resin and linen bandages

(C) [CORRECT] Secondary burial (post-excarnation burial of selected bones)

(D) Total cremation with ash scattered exclusively into the sea

Answer: (C) | *Concept: Secondary Burial Practice*

Explanation: Megalithic communities practiced 'secondary burial': bodies were first exposed to elements (excarnation) or temporarily interred; later, selected dry bones were collected and ritually deposited in the urn.

Q64. Which notable megalithic site in northern Kerala was excavated by the Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) in 2001?

(A) Pattanam

(B) Vizhinjam

(C) Kodungallur

(D) [CORRECT] Ummichipoyil

Answer: (D) | *Concept: Ummichipoyil Megalithic Excavation (2001)*

Explanation: The Ummichipoyil excavation in Kasaragod district, conducted in 2001 by the ASI, revealed rock-cut caves, iron weapons (swords, daggers, tridents), pottery, and carnelian beads in northern Kerala.

Q65. In megalithic excavations at Mangadu near Kollam, what significant artifact was recovered that indicated early iron metallurgy?

(A) [CORRECT] Iron daggers, iron slag, and a crucible inside urn burials

(B) A gold printing press

(C) A steam engine piston

(D) An electric wire insulator

Answer: (A) | *Concept: Mangadu Megalithic Findings*

Explanation: Excavations at Mangadu near Kollam revealed urn burials with iron daggers, terracotta figurines, and iron slag, providing radiocarbon dates around 900–1000 BCE.

Q66. What socio-religious belief is unequivocally demonstrated by the inclusion of food vessels, weapons, tools, and ornaments inside megalithic graves?

(A) Total disbelief in spiritual entities or post-mortem existence

(B) [CORRECT] Belief in an afterlife (life after death) and ancestor veneration

(C) Strict adherence to Protestant Christian theology

(D) A purely aesthetic attempt to empty household junk

Answer: (B) | *Concept: Belief in Afterlife and Ancestor Cult*

Explanation: Depositing personal weapons, pottery for food and drink, ornaments, and tools alongside the deceased proves that megalithic communities possessed a profound belief in life after death and actively propitiated ancestral spirits.

Q67. Sangam literature is generally dated between:

(A) 1000 BCE – 500 BCE

(B) 500 CE – 1000 CE

(C) [CORRECT] 300 BCE – 300 CE

(D) 1200 CE – 1500 CE

Answer: (C) | *Concept: Chronology of Sangam Literature*

Explanation: According to the official University LMS chapter-end assessment and mainstream historiography, Sangam literature is conventionally dated between 300 BCE and 300 CE.

Q68. Which of the following is an example of Akam literature?

(A) Purananuru

(B) Pathitrupathu

(C) Manimegalai

(D) [CORRECT] Akananuru

Answer: (D) | *Concept: Akam vs. Puram: Akananuru*

Explanation: According to the LMS assessment, Sangam poetry is classified into Akam (internal, personal, love poetics) and Puram (external, war, statecraft). Akananuru ('The 400 Love Poems') is the classic example of Akam.

Q69. The presiding deity of the Kurinji landscape in the Tinai concept is:

(A) [CORRECT] Murugan

(B) Indra

(C) Varuna

(D) Mayon

Answer: (A) | *Concept: Kurinji Tinai and Murugan*

Explanation: In the five-fold ecological Tinai concept, the Kurinji landscape (mountainous and forest tract) has as its presiding deity Murugan (Seyon, the red god of the hills and warfare).

Q70. Which landscape in the Tinai concept is associated with agriculture and fertile river valleys?

(A) Mullai

(B) [CORRECT] Marutam

(C) Neital

(D) Palai

Answer: (B) | *Concept: Marutam Tinai (Agrarian Plain)*

Explanation: Marutam denotes the fertile alluvial river plains dedicated to wet-paddy agriculture, associated with the deity Ventan (Indra) and the poetics of lovers' quarrels (udal).

Q71. The author of the celebrated ethical treatise Thirukkural is:

(A) Tolkappiyar

(B) Ilango Adigal

(C) [CORRECT] Thiruvalluvar

(D) Sattanar

Answer: (C) | *Concept: Thirukkural by Thiruvalluvar*

Explanation: The renowned didactic ethical masterpiece Thirukkural (comprising 1,330 couplets divided into Aram, Porul, and Inbam) was authored by the venerated Tamil philosopher Thiruvalluvar.

Q72. Which classical Greco-Roman text provides detailed navigational information about the ports of Muziris and Nelcynda?

(A) Geographia

(B) Natural History

(C) Indica

(D) [CORRECT] Periplus of the Erythraean Sea

Answer: (D) | *Concept: Periplus of the Erythraean Sea*

Explanation: The 'Periplus of the Erythraean Sea', written by an anonymous Greek navigator in the mid-1st century CE, provides an eyewitness sailing manual describing the route, anchorage, and trade goods at Muziris and Nelcynda.

Q73. Pattanam in Ernakulam district is widely identified by archaeologists with the ancient port of:

(A) [CORRECT] Muziris

(B) Arikamedu

(C) Korkai

(D) Nelcynda

Answer: (A) | *Concept: Pattanam Excavation & Muziris*

Explanation: Multi-season archaeological excavations at Pattanam near Kodungallur (conducted by KCHR) revealed extensive Mediterranean amphorae, terra sigillata, Roman glass, and a wharf, confirming it as the premier site of ancient Muziris.

Q74. The term 'Muvendar' in Sangam Tamil historiography refers to:

(A) Three major ports

(B) [CORRECT] Three crowned kings (Chera, Chola, and Pandya)

(C) Three religious traditions

(D) Three literary academies

Answer: (B) | *Concept: Muvendar: Three Crowned Kings*

Explanation: The term 'Muvendar' (Three Great Vendar) denotes the three sovereign crowned monarchs of ancient Tamilakam: the Cheras, the Cholas, and the Pandyas.

Q75. Which among the following was a famous Kurunila Mannar (Velir chieftain) known for ruling the hill tract of Parambu?

(A) Pegan

(B) Ori

(C) [CORRECT] Pari

(D) Nalli

Answer: (C) | *Concept: Vel Pari of Parambu Hill*

Explanation: Vel Pari was the most celebrated of the Seven Great Patrons (Kadaiyezhu Vallalgal), ruler of Parambu hill, renowned in Sangam poetry for his supreme generosity (offering his royal chariot to support a mullai creeper).

Q76. Hero stones erected in memory of fallen warriors in early Tamil society were known as:

(A) Menhirs

(B) Dolmens

(C) Cairns

(D) [CORRECT] Nadukal

Answer: (D) | *Concept: Nadukal (Hero Stones)*

Explanation: Nadukal (inscribed hero stones) were planted in honor of brave warriors who fell defending their village or recovering cattle from raiders, ritually worshipped by communities as described in the Purananuru.

Q77. Which Sangam anthology of the Ettuttokai collection is exclusively dedicated to praising the kings of the Chera dynasty?

(A) [CORRECT] Pathitrupathu

(B) Aingurunuru

(C) Kalittokai

(D) Paripadal

Answer: (A) | *Concept: Pathitrupathu and the Cheras*

Explanation: Pathitrupathu ('The Ten Tens') is composed of ten sets of ten poems, each decade celebrating the lineage, military conquests, administrative virtues, and royal charity of a specific Chera king of ancient Kerala.

Q78. Who authored the celebrated Tamil epic Silappadikaram, and what was his relationship to the Chera king Senguttuvan?

(A) Thiruvalluvar, who was the prime minister of Senguttuvan

(B) [CORRECT] Ilango Adigal, who was the younger brother of Cheran Senguttuvan

(C) Kapilar, who was the court priest of Senguttuvan

(D) Kambar, who was Senguttuvan's adopted son

Answer: (B) | *Concept: Silappadikaram and Ilango Adigal*

Explanation: Silappadikaram was composed by Ilango Adigal, an ascetic Jain prince who was the younger brother of the renowned Chera monarch Cheran Senguttuvan.

Q79. What is the royal heraldic emblem of the ancient Chera dynasty?

(A) Tiger

(B) Twin Fish (Carp)

(C) [CORRECT] Bow and Arrow

(D) Roaring Lion

Answer: (C) | *Concept: Chera Emblem: Bow and Arrow*

Explanation: The royal insignia of the Cheras was the Bow and Arrow (Villu). In contrast, the Cholas used the Tiger (Puli) and the Pandyas used the Twin Fish (Kayal).

Q80. Which 1st-century Roman naturalist famously lamented that Rome was drained of over 50 million sesterces annually to pay for Indian luxury goods like spices and pepper?

(A) Julius Caesar

(B) Marcus Aurelius

(C) Seneca

(D) [CORRECT] Pliny the Elder

Answer: (D) | *Concept: Pliny the Elder and the Roman Currency Drain*

Explanation: In his encyclopedic work 'Naturalis Historia' (77 CE), Pliny the Elder lamented the enormous economic drain of Roman gold and silver to India to satisfy Roman demand for Malabar pepper, fine muslin, and gems.

Q81. What 4th-century Roman road map depicts South India and explicitly marks a temple dedicated to Emperor Augustus at Muziris ('Templum Augusti')?

(A) [CORRECT] Tabula Peutingeriana (Peutinger Table)

(B) Magna Carta

(C) Domesday Book

(D) Ebstorf Map

Answer: (A) | *Concept: Tabula Peutingeriana and the Temple of Augustus*

Explanation: The 'Tabula Peutingeriana' is an illustrated road map of the Roman cursus publicus which depicts the Malabar coast, marking 'Muziris' alongside an icon indicating the 'Templum Augusti' (Temple of Augustus), proving a permanent Roman mercantile settlement.

Q82. What is the primary historical value of the 2nd-century CE Greek document known as the 'Vienna Papyrus' (Muziris Papyrus)?

(A) It lists the family tree of Alexander the Great in India

(B) [CORRECT] It contains a maritime trade and loan agreement for a massive cargo of Malabar black pepper and ivory on the ship Hermapollon

(C) It provides the text of the Upanishads translated into Greek

(D) It describes the recipes for preparing Kerala fish curry

Answer: (B) | *Concept: The Vienna Papyrus (Muziris Papyrus)*

Explanation: The Vienna Papyrus (P. Vindob. G 40822) contains a legal commercial loan contract between an Alexandria financier and a merchant concerning cargo on the ship 'Hermapollon' loaded with Muziris pepper, Gangetic nard, and ivory evaluated at several million sesterces.

Q83. Which indigenous sea-traders and salt manufacturers are frequently mentioned in Sangam literature as traveling in caravans with bullock carts?

(A) Vellalar

(B) Anjuvannam

(C) [CORRECT] Umanar

(D) Manigramam

Answer: (C) | *Concept: Umanar Salt Traders*

Explanation: The 'Umanar' were the coastal salt manufacturers and overland merchants described in Sangam poetry traveling in long bullock-cart caravans (Umana Chattu) into the interior hills to barter salt for hill products and grains.

Q84. Which title was commonly adopted by the rulers of the Chera kingdom of Mahodayapuram?

(A) Maharajadhiraja

(B) Gajapati

(C) Chakravarti

(D) [CORRECT] Perumal

Answer: (D) | *Concept: The Royal Title 'Perumal'*

Explanation: According to the LMS assessment, the paramount rulers of the Second Chera Kingdom of Mahodayapuram (c. 800–1122 CE) held the distinctive dynastic title of 'Perumal' (or Cheraman Perumal).

Q85. The advisory council that assisted the Chera Perumal in religious and temple affairs was known as:

(A) [CORRECT] Nalu Thali

(B) Sabha

(C) Nagaram

(D) Ur

Answer: (A) | *Concept: Nalu Thali (Four Royal Temple Assemblies)*

Explanation: According to the LMS assessment, the Nalu Thali comprised representatives from the four major Brahmin temple assemblies of Mahodayapuram (Nityavichareswaram, Parameswaram, Melthali, and Nediyathali) who acted as the paramount council advising the Perumal.

Q86. The members of the Nalu Thali were known as:

(A) Naduvazhis

(B) [CORRECT] Thali Adhikarikal

(C) Uralars

(D) Karalars

Answer: (B) | *Concept: Thali Adhikarikal*

Explanation: According to the LMS assessment, the presiding heads/representatives of each of the four council temples forming the Nalu Thali were officially styled 'Thali Adhikarikal' (or Thaliyatiris).

Q87. Which official acted as the principal representative of the king and presided over village assemblies?

(A) Menon

(B) Adhikaran

(C) [CORRECT] Koyil Adhikarikal

(D) Prakriti

Answer: (C) | *Concept: Koyil Adhikarikal (Crown Representative)*

Explanation: According to the LMS assessment, the 'Koyil Adhikarikal' was typically a member of the royal family or crown prince who functioned as the king's supreme executive officer and personal deputy presiding over important state and local assemblies.

Q88. The elite bodyguard of the Chera Perumal was known as:

(A) Nattuttayar

(B) Arunnurruvar

(C) Anchuvannam

(D) [CORRECT] Ayiram

Answer: (D) | *Concept: The Royal Bodyguard: Ayiram ('The Thousand')*

Explanation: According to the LMS assessment, the personal military bodyguard force sworn to protect the Perumal was known as 'Ayiram' (The Thousand, such as the Onnu Kure Ayiram of Kodungallur), acting as lethal suicide shock troops in war.

Q89. Which of the following was an annual land tax during the Chera period?

(A) [CORRECT] Attaikkol

(B) Rakshabhoga

(C) Aranthai

(D) Kutimai

Answer: (A) | *Concept: Attaikkol (Annual Land Revenue)*

Explanation: According to the LMS assessment, 'Attaikkol' was the mandatory annual land revenue tax paid to the crown or state by landholders and tenants during the Chera Perumal kingdom.

Q90. The urban administrative body in the Chera kingdom was called:

(A) Sabha

(B) [CORRECT] Nagaram

(C) Ur

(D) Nadu

Answer: (B) | *Concept: Nagaram (Urban Commercial Assembly)*

Explanation: According to the LMS assessment, 'Nagaram' was the autonomous civic and trade administration body representing commercial market towns and merchant settlements in the Chera kingdom.

Q91. The binding resolutions passed by village assemblies in medieval Kerala were known as:

(A) Viruthi

(B) Kanam

(C) [CORRECT] Kachchams

(D) Cherikkal

Answer: (C) | *Concept: Kachchams (Constitutional Resolutions)*

Explanation: According to the LMS assessment, 'Kachchams' were formal constitutional resolutions and statutory agreements enacted by assemblies (such as the famous Muzhikkulam Kachcham) to govern temple property, tenancy rights, and administrative duties.

Q92. Which eminent historian argued that the Chera Perumals followed a patrilineal system with a council of Brahmin oligarchs, rather than matrilineal succession?

(A) Elamkulam P. N. Kunjan Pillai

(B) Rajan Gurukkal

(C) Kesavan Veluthat

(D) [CORRECT] M. G. S. Narayanan

Answer: (D) | *Concept: M.G.S. Narayanan on Chera Perumal Succession*

Explanation: According to the LMS assessment and epigraphic research, Prof. M.G.S. Narayanan (author of 'Perumals of Kerala') proved through inscriptional evidence that the Chera Perumals followed patrilineal succession (father to son), refuting older theories.

Q93. The capital of the Chera Perumal kingdom, Mahodayapuram, has been identified with present-day:

(A) [CORRECT] Kodungallur

(B) Kollam

(C) Kozhikode

(D) Kannur

Answer: (A) | *Concept: Identification of Mahodayapuram with Kodungallur*

Explanation: According to the LMS assessment, Mahodayapuram (Makotai or Mahodayapattanam), the majestic fortified capital of the Second Cheras, has been conclusively identified with present-day Kodungallur in Thrissur district.

Q94. Which is the earliest dated epigraph discovered in Kerala, issued in 830 CE in Vattezhuttu script?

(A) Tarisapalli Copper Plates

(B) [CORRECT] Vazhappally Inscription

(C) Jewish Copper Plates of Cochin

(D) Parthivapuram Copper Plates

Answer: (B) | *Concept: Vazhappally Inscription (830 CE)*

Explanation: The Vazhappally Inscription, discovered near Changanassery, is dated to 830 CE (the 12th regnal year of Rajashekhara Varman). Written in Vattezhuttu script, it is the earliest available epigraphical record from Kerala.

Q95. The famous Tarisapalli Copper Plates of 849 CE were granted to which West Asian merchant leader by Ayyanadikal Tiruvadikal, the governor of Venad?

(A) Joseph Rabban

(B) Sulaiman al-Tajir

(C) [CORRECT] Mar Sapir Iso

(D) Vasco da Gama

Answer: (C) | *Concept: Tarisapalli Copper Plates & Mar Sapir Iso*

Explanation: The Tarisapalli Plates (issued at Kollam in 849 CE during the reign of Sthanu Ravi Varma) granted land, agricultural serfs, and 72 commercial privileges to Mar Sapir Iso, the leader of the West Asian Christian merchants.

Q96. The Jewish Copper Plates of Cochin (1000 CE), issued by Bhaskara Ravi Varman I at Muyirikkode, conferred 72 royal prerogatives on which Jewish leader?

(A) Benjamin of Tudela

(B) Mar Sapir Iso

(C) Ezekiel Rahabi

(D) [CORRECT] Joseph Rabban

Answer: (D) | *Concept: Jewish Copper Plates of Cochin & Joseph Rabban*

Explanation: The Jewish Copper Plates (dated to 1000 CE) granted hereditary royal honors (such as traveling in palanquins, blowing trumpet horns, daytime lanterns, and tax remissions) to Jewish merchant leader Joseph Rabban, appointing him head of the Anjuvannam guild.

Q97. What kind of guild was 'Anjuvannam' in medieval Kerala epigraphy?

(A) [CORRECT] A powerful commercial corporation primarily comprising West Asian foreign merchants (Jews, Christians, and Muslims)

(B) An indigenous village potter corporation

(C) A military guild of archery trainers

(D) A theatrical troupe performing Koodiyattam

Answer: (A) | *Concept: Anjuvannam Merchant Guild*

Explanation: Anjuvannam (Hanjamana) was an autonomous trans-oceanic merchant guild operating along peninsular ports, predominantly composed of foreign maritime traders including West Asian Christians, Jews, and Arabs.

Q98. What was the celebrated Vedic educational academy established in 866 CE by Ay King Karunandadakkan in southern Kerala?

(A) Nalanda Mahavihara

(B) [CORRECT] Kanthalur Salai (Parthivapuram Salai)

(C) Taxila University

(D) Vikramashila University

Answer: (B) | *Concept: Kanthalur Salai and Parthivapuram Salai*

Explanation: Kanthalur Salai (and its sister Parthivapuram Salai established by King Karunandadakkan in 866 CE) was a renowned armed Vedic boarding academy providing advanced education in Sanskrit, scriptures, logic, and military arts.

Q99. In the agrarian feudal structure of the Chera kingdom, what were the hereditary trustees of temple properties called?

(A) Karalar

(B) Kudiyar

(C) [CORRECT] Uralar

(D) Chaver

Answer: (C) | *Concept: Uralar (Temple Trustees)*

Explanation: In medieval Kerala, temple committees were headed by 'Uralar' (hereditary Brahmin trustees) who exercised autocratic control over vast Devaswom and Brahmaswom temple estates and tenant rents.

Q100. Which historic resolution passed by a temple assembly in the 9th century became the supreme model code of conduct across Kerala for managing temple property and penalizing corrupt Uralar?

(A) Kadammanitta Agreement

(B) Treaty of Mavelikkara

(C) Edict of Milan

(D) [CORRECT] Muzhikkulam Kachcham

Answer: (D) | *Concept: Muzhikkulam Kachcham*

Explanation: Enacted at Muzhikkulam temple during the reign of Sthanu Ravi or his predecessor, the Muzhikkulam Kachcham laid down strict statutory penalties (forfeiture of trustee rights, confiscation of land) for corrupt Uralar, becoming the constitutional precedent for all later Kerala Kachchams.